

New Intel SSDs coming

Intel to launch its next generation of solid state drives in the first quarter of 2011



Some of the cell phone deals include free Bluetooth headsets

movie releases in 3D have helped too.

The most common free offering with TVs are the free wall mount with free installation. Some dealers might try and charge you for the installation, but you should know that the manufacturers themselves are now providing this service free of cost, so refuse to buy from someone who doesn't install for free, if you're buying a big brand TV.

If you don't need the wall mount, try your best to get a further discount on the price. If all else fails, take the wall mount, even if you don't need it now – you might want one later, and no use paying for one later when it's available for free now. Besides, you could also

MOP? MRP?

Maximum retail prices can differ vastly from market operating prices. As we've mentioned before, never pay as per MRP in consumer tech. The MOP is the actual street price.

Most "discounts" are given on the MRP, in order for them to appear to be at a higher percentage. So a product that has an MRP of ₹1,000, but is actually sold at ₹550, might be offered to you at a whopping discount of 50 per cent. Which is basically an actual price drop of ₹50, masquerading as a ₹500 discount! Sneaky, huh? It's best to monitor prices of things you want to buy before the sales begin, and then decide if you're actually getting a good deal.



gift it to someone who does need it.

Many brands that make TVs also manufacture related consumer electronics products such as home theater systems, DVD and Blu-ray players, or other kinds of audio-video equipment. Expect entertainment bundles from such brands on TVs of higher values. You will find Blu-ray players and HDMI cables bundled. Again, remember that the prices of these products are bound to be exaggerated. For example, if you're buying an LCD TV for ₹70,000, and there's an offer to bundle a Blu-ray player and home theatre worth ₹50,000 – that's obviously exaggerated.

Also, we are fond of 3D, but not

3D TVs. It's always best to wait until more movie titles are available. Only the rich can afford to be early adopters, the rest of us should wait and get a good deal on the technology when it's matured and when it makes sense.

Bundled movie titles are also a common offer, but may or may not matter much to you, depending on how fast your internet connection is. Also make sure you look at the variety of choice, because the movies are usually the ones you would *not* buy.

Deals to avoid are the ones that aren't related at all. I found some deals of a free internet connection with a TV. You want an internet connection, choose one wisely, don't just accept one along with a TV...

The same applies for a DTH service. Although it may sound like a good deal, make sure you do your research on the DTH service provider. You can opt for this if it happens to be the DTH provider you were going to opt for anyway.

Free bundles might also include products that are advertised without model numbers or details. Avoid these deals, because you're probably going to get the lowest-end model of all. One example I saw was "Free DVD-player with 42-inch LCD TV".

Laptops

Laptops are another big category of products being sold in the market. Usually, individuals are the ones buying them, not families. So this is a category where you should be sure of your needs, and make sure you buy something that's right for you. Laptop prices do dip in the festive season, but not as much as home theaters or TVs.

Daily Online Deals

If you are tired waiting for deals, there are a few sites online that have regular deals. They aren't the absolute best deals available, but they will save you the trouble of running around crowded malls and streets hunting for them. There are quite a few sites online, but very few of them are based in India. One of the more relevant ones is Bindas Bargain (www.bindasbargain.com). The site has new products with discounts being put up everyday. Not all of their products are consumer electronics, but every couple of days, you'll find stuff like DVD players, Bluetooth headsets, phones, etc being sold. Similarly, Loot More (www.lootmore.com) offers deals on electronics and PC peripherals. Prices are more or less the same as in retail, but you get free shipping on most of the products. 123Loot (www.123loot.com) is another similar site which isn't as pretty looking as the previous two, but has quite a lot of cameras, speakers, phones, storage drives and other PC and laptop accessories being sold regularly.



Bindasbargain.com



Lootmore.com